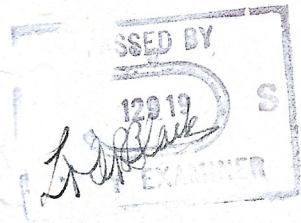


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12th Mobile R.R. Sq.
H.P.O. 636 9th R.M.
N.Y.N.Y.



Miss MARTHA DARROUGH
LUTHERAN Hospital,
School of Nursing,
St. Louis, Mo.

No. 23, 934
England?

My Dearest Martha,

I. day is my day off and I am
in town at the American Red Cross. The day
is very nice out. A little cold but a lot
of sun shine. I hope that you have some nice
weather when you read this letter.

A couple of days ago was Thanksgiving.
That is the day you eat until you open your
belly a skint. Well, we had a lot & eat
I guess I do not have to tell you all
we did have. I had a big piece of white
meat (the part I like best) and was it good. The
first bite I took sure remembered me of
home. As we would get the whole family to
gather that day. And eat until we could eat
more. And then was sure a lot of ^{times} ~~times~~
that I could not move. I hope that you
had enough to eat that day.

In the afternoon, I went to Church in town.
It was a big service given by the 8th Air Force.
There was a lot of Yank & also a lot of high

important men there. I saw Gen. Doolittle, who is head of the 8th Air Force. It really made me feel good to see a man who had bombed all the Axis Capitals. He saw loads of ribbons. There was a lot of English officers there too. They made a record of it. And with a big broadcast it came later that night.

That night I went to a dance, The Red Cross gave it. And it was very nice. It was the first dance I ever went to where the girls wore evening dresses. For as you know I just started to learn over here. Therefore I never went to any at home. But I will sure give them a good going over when I get back. The music was good, and I thought I did my best dancing that night. I ~~had~~ did not ask the girl what she thought. Because I know the censor will not have those words go through. That is about all I did that day.

I hope you had a very nice day. Can you tell a guy? Of course it is not like home but it was good.

For the last 2 or 3 days I have been feeling very good. I am very happy. I guess the reason is because I got a lot of mail. I got my

mother's long awaited birthday card. and a lot of letters from her. But I also got one from you. which needed to be answered today. I will get to that very soon. I told you that I was feeling good with I was feeling so good that I wrote some thing. I am just wondering if I should send it to you? I can refer this letter as it would really make a mess out of it.

But now to your letter a I should say letters. as there are two of them. The first one you wrote on my birthday. which is wishing me a happy birthday. and I must thank you for the card & the nice letter. There is a lot in this letter I would like to copy. But I just you do not want to read your stuff a gain. But you have a very nice way of putting it. that I could never do in a long time.

Martha dear, I have been sitting here for the last 10 minutes trying to think of what to say about your letter. I can not leave it go bye & do not want to leave it go bye. You are telling me just how much you care. I told you one night in the back of the nurses home that I wanted to hear how much you liked me. That was a lot a year ago. I never said anything more to you about it. Because I know you would tell me if you really cared. and now I get this letter.

In which you told me just where I stand with you. It is the most beautiful thing I read. I think I will keep that the rest of my life. I have read it over so much that I can tell you just what it says by heart.

I have been beating around the bush long enough. So tell you, that I miss you a lot & a great understatement. I miss you a great deal. But you're dearest as long as I'm over here & you are over there we can not do much about it now. So I guess we will just have to wait until I can get back & see you. There is so many things that are different since I last saw you.

Right now, you rank "a" number 1 in my heart & mind & every time I think of it & about you & what you are doing. I would love to go a great distance to see you & to hold you in my arms once again. I guess you know that you are the first person I want to see when I get back home. Of course, I love to see the family first. But nothing else comes after that. In fact if you are at home, I might see you first before I get to St. Louis. But do not worry, I must really do what to see you. Then we got to go to a lot of things that we never did. Like those long rides home back roads. The short ride & a couple

good night in the park. then if we get to know each other better that we did ~~the first~~ ^{the first} time thing may be done about it.

I can not tell you I wait as you may find some body else. that you like better. And I do not want you to wait because it may happen to me. I do not want to put you eyes up to high. As I have change a lot. And you may not want me like I am. This year away from home has really changed me. I can not tell you just what ways that you will surely find out. They are little thing which you may not care for.

You would not want to see a hear from me if some thing happen to me. And I would not write any more if any thing did happen. That is why I did not leave any thing at home. That is why I wanted the ring back. ~~and~~ and about the ring maybe we can do a lot better when I get back.

L. nature is about lets me say this. I want you to care & love me. As I do you so very much. Until the time comes that we can see each other again. I would like to know just what you ~~like~~ ^{think} about all this. I know I did a very poor job of telling you about it. But I was never very good at writing my thoughts down.

Now I would like to say a few things about your letters. I'm sorry you did not hear from me as much as you should, but I do not have as much time. You see I go to town a lot. But I get away mid off home. Because you go into visiting & camp all the time. If I did say then I would never have a chance to do any thing I like.

You know you self that if you could go to your room after the day is over. And just write to me that pretty soon you would have to write. But this way there is time between our letters. For us to have a good time. I answer all your letters. And every time I get one I write one. In fact a week or two ago I did not hear from you so I wrote one to fill in the space.

My mother has got the same idea that I should write so much as I did. But to tell you the truth I think I write now. Then when I first got here here. As you can see for your self it is my 6 pages. I guess I must have to get my own mail service & your mother. How is that for you?

You said that I should not get tight. Well that is one thing I do not think I will do for a long time. For it does not interest me to get like that. Just a couple of Quicks is enough for me. But I will still take a chocolate wafer fast.

It looks like we both thought the other one changed. That's why our letters changed

to. I hope that it is fixed up now. For my part it is.

I can see your explanation about the other sailors & Saldies. For if you like me body you want every body to like me too. I could add one other reason why we should should go out with other people. And if I do go out with other. and then still like you a lot better. You know just when you stand and look at the top. I told you Bob was want you to get out of practice. So keep right on telling me about them as I will not get mad as long as I know you feel this way about me. But I do want you to write if there is any change.

You also said some thing about your roommates noticing how you feel. Well, I got a story to tell you about that. I mailed you a birthday card on the wall of the barracks. With a lot of pin up girl I got. Well the boys read the back. When you said that you love me. and put it in it. No body over here call me hipp but they started to read. So you see what you did. I also got your picture in my footlocker. And they all ask who you are & all about you.

I just told them. You are a very beautiful girl & you are a nurse. That I had a lot of good times with. And we are going to do a lot of things after I get back. Of course, I do not tell them how much

I want to see you & to hold you in my arms. and how much I think about those nights we had together. because those are ours. to be with us until we can do some thing better.

I am going to have to stop this letter pretty soon. because of a couple good reasons. First I got only one more sheet of paper. that I brought with me. and then the censor is getting nastier. and I think your eyes are getting tired of this. But I got a couple more things to say to you. You will really have to take heart & get any thing in when I get back as you can see by this letter.

I am glad you got the pictures or I got a couple more you may like. When I get some more made I will send them to you. But they got the same hair-do. I never had a change & comb it. I do not go for those pictures where you take horses getting fixed up. and then next are really show that. The dog is one of the dogs who lived in the next barracks. He went home 2 months ago. as he has been over here 2 years.

We got a dog that barks at all the English men in camp. Every time we shall be is right there with us.

Page 9.; of Book I; last Chapter.

I will be looking forward to these 10 days. now
Did I win there off note Dave. I guess I better start
on cards & make money, as it is the end of the month.
and only 30 more days until Christmas.

I got every thing in this letter but a joke & saying.
to be about this; "Heat Wave" "a rule, explaining
to police why he turned in a false alarm, said he
had been standing on a corner minding his
own business when a super-super-looking
WAVE stralked by. & he was so beautiful,
the G-b said, he swooned, falling against
the alarm box, which set off the alarm."

I have used so many ways of closing I
can not think of a good one, which I would like
to do at this time.

I miss you a great deal. And pray for the
day that I can have you back in my arm kissing
you again.

I love you deeply
Boys.